FDE SCENARIO DRILLS #03

FDE SCENARIO DRILLS · ISSUE 03 OF 08

The pod that could not reach the LLM.

Scenario: works on your laptop, times out in their cluster.

03

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Swipe →

Walk the path out

1. DNS resolves the API host?
2. Route to NAT or proxy?
3. Egress allows 443?
4. Corporate proxy intercepting TLS?
5. Domain on the allowlist?

> Run each check from inside the pod with nslookup and curl -v, not from your laptop.

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What it usually is

01 No NAT route

Private subnet with no NAT gateway or Cloud NAT.

02 Forced proxy

Egress must go through a proxy the app does not use.

03 TLS inspection

Proxy re-signs certificates the client does not trust.

04 Allowlist

The provider domain was never approved.

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Fix options

QUICK

- Set HTTPS_PROXY for the app
- Add the corporate CA bundle
- Request the domain allowlist

BETTER

- Private connectivity to the model
- Model endpoint in their cloud
- Egress via one audited gateway

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THE QUESTION TO ASK ON DAY ONE

“How does traffic leave this network?”

Asking in week one saves the go-live day.

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What interviewers listen for

- [x] Systematic, layer by layer
- [x] Tests from inside the workload
- [x] Knows proxies and TLS inspection
- [x] Offers a quick fix and a better one
- [x] Prevents it in the next project

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KEY TAKEAWAY

Ask how traffic leaves the network before you build.

→ Debug from inside the pod

→ Check DNS, route, rule, proxy, allowlist

→ Prefer private model endpoints

YOUR TURN

What was the strangest network blocker you have hit on a customer site?

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